

Harry W. Bass Jr. School of Arts, Humanities, and Technology

Visual and Performing Arts (BA) with Theatre Concentration

Students who complete the major in Visual and Performing Arts (VPA) pursue an interdisciplinary study of the arts by completing a major core that includes courses in writing, interdisciplinary studies, professional development, historical context, theory, and practice. The VPA major culminates in a Senior Capstone. Students who are majoring in VPA can focus their studies by choosing from nine possible concentrations.

The Theatre concentration focuses on student work in areas of theatre including: Acting, Stage Management, Technical Theatre, Design, Musical Theatre, Directing, Voice Over, Playwriting, Dance, and Production Ensemble. Additionally, students will develop knowledge in theatre history and literature.

At least one-half of the total semester credit hours for major requirements must be taken at UT Dallas.

Unless otherwise noted, courses in Visual and Performing Arts are open to all students in the University.

Bachelor of Arts in Visual and Performing Arts with Theatre Concentration

[Degree Requirements](#) (120 semester credit hours)

[View an Example of Degree Requirements by Semester](#)

Faculty

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Professors: Fred I. Curchack, Thomas Riccio

Clinical Assistant Professor: Shelby Hibbs

Professor of Instruction: Kathy Lingo

I. Core Curriculum Requirements: 42 semester credit hours¹

Communication: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Communication Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Mathematics: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Mathematics Core](#) courses

Life and Physical Sciences: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Life and Physical Sciences Core](#) courses

Language, Philosophy and Culture: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Language, Philosophy and Culture Core](#) courses

Creative Arts: 3 semester credit hours

[THEA 1310](#) Understanding Theatre²

Or select any 3 semester credit hours from [Creative Arts Core](#) courses (see advisor)

American History: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [American History Core](#) courses

Government/Political Science: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Government/Political Science Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Social and Behavioral Sciences: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Social and Behavioral Sciences Core](#) courses

Component Area Option: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Component Area Option Core](#) courses

II. Major Requirements, Lower-Division: 6 semester credit hours beyond Core Curriculum

[THEA 1310](#) Understanding Theatre²

3 semester credit hours from a [THEA](#) studio course, including:

[THEA 1351](#) Acting 1

[THEA 1352](#) Acting 2

[THEA 2311](#) Topics in Theatre

[THEA 2364](#) Musical Theatre Workshop

[THEA 2371](#) Technical Theatre 1

[THEA 2372](#) Improvisation

[THEA 2373](#) Languages of the Body

[THEA 2V71](#) Independent Study in Theatre

[THEA 2350](#) Voice for the Actor

3 semester credit hours from a [THEA/DANC/MUSI](#) studio ensemble course

III. Major Requirements, Upper-Division: 39 semester credit hours

Major Core Courses: 15 semester credit hours

[VPAS 3340](#) Writing in the Arts

[VPAS 4389](#) Theory and Practice of the Visual and Performing Arts

[VPAS 4390](#) Senior Capstone

or [VPAS 4V99](#) Senior Honors in Visual and Performing Art

3 semester credit hours of upper-level Related Courses from the School of Arts, Humanities, and Technology (excluding the THEA prefix)

Select 3 semester credit hours of Professional Development Courses from the following:

[ARTS 3311](#) Contemporary Art Practices

[ARTS 4310](#) Studies in Contemporary Exhibitions

[COMM 4370](#) Communication and Leadership

[COMM 4371](#) Communication and Professionalism

[ENTP 3301](#) Innovation and Entrepreneurship

[ISAH 4V50](#) Internship

[VPAS 4310](#) Entertainment Law

Theatre Concentration Requirements: 24 semester credit hours

[THEA 3323](#) Performance in Historical Context

[THEA 3310](#) Theatre/Performance Ensemble

or 3 semester credit hours of [THEA 3V10](#) Technical Theatre Practicum

12 semester credit hours of upper-level [THEA](#) courses

3 semester credit hours of upper-division [THEA/DANC/MUSI](#) courses

3 semester credit hours of upper-division Visual and Performing Arts elective

IV. Elective Requirements: 33 semester credit hours

Free Electives: 33 semester credit hours

Both upper- and lower-division courses may be used as electives. Students are encouraged to enroll in courses in other performance areas, such as dance and music.

The plan must include sufficient upper-division courses to total 45 upper-division semester credit hours.

Incoming freshmen must enroll and complete requirements of [AHTC 1100](#).

Minors

Students must take a minimum of 18 semester credit hours for the minor. Students who take a minor will be expected to meet the normal prerequisites in courses making up the minor, and should maintain a minimum GPA of 2.000 on a 4.00 scale (C average). Semester credit hours may not be used to satisfy both the major and minor requirements; however, free elective semester credit hours or major preparatory classes may be used to satisfy the minor. Core courses offered by the school may count as lower-division semester credit hours toward the minor. Topics courses must be approved by the school. The School of Arts, Humanities, and Technology will substitute courses as necessary. At least one-third of the semester credit hours for a minor must be taken at The University of Texas at Dallas.

Minor in Theatre

18 semester credit hours

Theatre Fundamentals: 3 semester credit hours

Choose one course from the following:

[THEA 1310](#) Understanding Theatre

[THEA 1351](#) Acting 1

[THEA 1352](#) Acting 2

[THEA 2364](#) Musical Theatre Workshop

Performance and Technical Study: 6 semester credit hours

Performance: 3 semester credit hours

Choose one course from the following:

[THEA 2371](#) Technical Theatre 1

[THEA 2372](#) Improvisation

[THEA 2373](#) Languages of the Body

[THEA 2350](#) Voice for the Actor

[THEA 2V71](#) Independent Study in Theatre (1-3 semester credit hours)

[THEA 3310](#) Theatre/Performance Ensemble

Technical Study: 3 semester credit hours

Choose one course from the following:

[THEA 3324](#) Technical Theatre 2

[THEA 3325](#) Directing

[THEA 3351](#) Light Design

[THEA 3352](#) Stage Management

[THEA 3353](#) Theatrical Makeup

[THEA 3V10](#) Technical Theatre Practicum

Theatre History and Literature: 3 semester credit hours

Choose one course from the following:

[THEA 3323](#) Performance in Historical Context

[THEA 3380](#) Theatre and Literature

Electives: 6 semester credit hours, upper-division coursework

6 semester credit hours of any upper-level [THEA](#) courses

1. Curriculum Requirements can be fulfilled by other approved courses from institutions of higher education. The courses listed are recommended as the most efficient way to satisfy both Core Curriculum and Major Requirements at UT Dallas.

2. A required Preparatory course that also fulfills a Core Curriculum requirement. Semester credit hours may be counted in Core Curriculum.

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